

Renaissance Timeline until 1492 – Significant Events that will Shape our Election

Black = Italy/culture; Green = Papacy; Red = England/France war; Blue = East/at sea; Purple = Europe's thrones

- 1095 The First Crusade begins; crusading will continue on & off until the early 1500s
- 1125-86 First Guelph-Ghibelline faction war in Italy. Second war begins 1216 & drags on until 1392
- 1154 House of Plantagenet become Kings of England 1204 Venice sacks Constantinople (4th Crusade)
- 1265 Birth of Dante Alighieri 1273 House of Hapsburg become (Holy Roman) Emperors
- 1282-1301 Ghibellines defeated in Florence, new civil war between Black Guelphs & White Guelphs
- 1293 House D'Este comes firmly to power in Ferrara (Italy, south of Venice)
- 1303 Death of Pope Boniface VIII in feud w/ King Philip IV of France, who moves papacy to Avignon
- 1304 Birth of Petrarch 1313 Birth of Boccaccio 1321 Death of Dante 1324 Death of Marco Polo
- 1328 House of Valois become kings of France (1326 First recorded reference to gun in Europe)
- 1336 Beginning of 100 years' war (French House of Valois vs. English Plantagenet over French throne)
- 1341 Petrarch crowned Poet Laureate in Rome 1342-2 Walter of Brienne tries to conquer Florence
- 1348 BLACK DEATH**
- 1350 to 1421 Florentine Empire expands across Tuscany, Venice begins its third war against Genoa
- 1369 House of Trastámara become Kings of Castile (in Spain) (1374 Petrarch dies, 1375 Boccaccio dies)
- 1378 Gregory XI dies, Avignon Papacy becomes Western Schism (2 popes at once!); Florence rocked by popular Ciompi Revolt; 4th Venice-Genoa war. 1386 England-Portugal alliance begins
- 1389-1402 Big wars between Milan & Florence; 1392 2nd Guelph-Ghibelline war finally formally ends
- 1406 Florence captures Pisa 1412 A Branch of Castile's House of Trastámara become Kings of Aragon
- 1415 England's Henry V defeats the French at Agincourt, strengthening England's efforts in France
- 1414-1418 Council of Constance ends Avignon Papacy; Poggio Bracciolini crosses the Alps seeking books
- 1419 Leonardo Bruni publishes a history of Florence in which he invents the "Dark Ages"
- 1424 Filippo Maria Visconti Viceroy of Milan besieges Florence (unsuccessfully), Venice also fights Milan
- 1430 Joan of Arc burnt at the stake by the British (part of the Hundred Years' War)
- 1433-4 Exile & return of Cosimo de Medici (Medici rising to power), Birth of Marsilio Ficino
- 1443 Alfonso I of Aragon takes Naples from France (started trying 1421) aided by Milan + Sforza
- 1437-1449 Councils of Ferrara/Florence attempt to unite Catholic & Eastern Churches. It mostly works!
- 1447 Tommaso Parentucelli (Genoese) elected Pope Nicholas V (into humanism, founds Vatican library)
- 1450 **Gutenberg's printing press**, Francesco Sforza secures the Duchy of Milan
- 1453 **Constantinople captured by the Ottomans ending Eastern Empire, end of 100 Years' War**
- 1455 Alfonso de Borja elected Pope Callixtus III; Wars of the Roses begin, "Peace of Lodi" Venice/Milan
- 1457 King of Hungary dies w/o heir, Pope Callixtus helps Matthias Corvinus "the Raven King" to throne
- 1458 Pope Callixtus III dies, the scholarly Aeneas Silvius Piccolomini (Sienese) elected Pope Pius II
- 1464 Death of Pope Pius II, Pietro Barbo (Venetian) elected Pope Paul II. Death of Cosimo de Medici, leaving Florence to Piero; Milan conquers Genoa (Giovanni Pico della Mirandola born 1463)
- 1469 Wedding of Ferdinand and Isabella, Death of Piero de Medici, Lorenzo inherits, Birth of Machiavelli
- 1471 Francesco della Rovere (Genoese, Franciscan) Elected Pope Sixtus IV (Michelangelo born 1475)
- 1476 Duke Galeazzo Maria Sforza of Milan assassinated, crown goes to son Gian Galeazzo, power to brother Ludovico. Beatrice of Naples marries Matthias Corvinus of Hungary (the "Raven King")
- 1477 Duchess Mary of Burgundy marries Charles the Bold, son of Emperor Maximilian, joining Empire
- 1478 Pazzi Conspiracy Pope Sixtus vs. Medici + ensuing wars; Milan loses Genoa; Genoa fights Venice
- 1478-81 Venice defeats Genoa & makes peace w/ Ottomans. Ottomans invade Italy sacking Otranto. Sultan Mehmet II dies suddenly, civil war for Ottoman throne, Bayezid II wins, banishing his brother Cem.
- 1481 Joao II comes to the throne of Portugal, banishing Portugal's strong nobles & initiating reform
- 1484 Henry Tudor becomes King Henry VII of England, Ending Wars of the Roses, death of Pope Sixtus, Giovanni Battista Cybo (Genoese) elected Pope Innocent VIII (Martin Luther born 1483)
- 1484 Ficino's complete Plato translation released; Pico della Mirandola comes to Florence
- 1486 Maximilian elected Emperor, and made King of the Romans, but not yet crowned...
- 1488 Duke of Brittany dies passing Duchy to 11-year-old Duchess Anne; Milan conquers Genoa again
- 1490 Matthias Corvinus of Hungary dies w/o an heir, widowed Queen Beatrice chooses Vladislaus as king
- 1491 Charles of France forces Anne of Brittany to marry him instead of Emperor Maximilian. **It begins...**